



# Linux Games

## You Should Play, and Make!

Discover the various aspects of gaming in Linux. Here are a few suggestions on the online material readers can use, if they wish to develop their own games, as well as pointers to various available Linux games.

Many years ago when I was a wee lad, there existed a wondrous machine called the Sinclair ZX Spectrum. It was an 8-bit computer that originally came out in 1982, and I had the privilege of owning the 128 version, which, as its name suggests, had a princely 128KB of RAM, a 3.5MHz processor, and, wonder of wonders, a 3-channel sound chip. It had a version of the BASIC language in the ROM, which meant that when it powered up, you were ready to program—a far cry from today's multi-minute boot times. This was the machine I spent my teenage years on, cut my coding teeth on, and which enabled me to make many friends on the game-swapping scene at school. The games were available on *cassette tapes*. Now, why am I telling you this long story? Well, it turns out that the wonderful people at [worldofspectrum.org](http://worldofspectrum.org) have put just about every game I ever

played on my Spectrum online (and this has been the case for a long time, now). These games can be played *inside a browser*, via a Java emulator! That's right... my baby, my constant companion throughout my childhood years, the very reason I'm writing this today, is now a *Web page*!

The emulator worked out-of-the-box for me on Fedora 20 with Firefox. Go to the site, and go to Sinclair Infoseek, where you can type in the name of any game you like. Once you get the search result, you'll find links to the cassette inlays, which have the instructions for the game, and, well, I leave it up to you to figure out which button to click to get the game to play... 'an exercise left to the reader'. Let me warn you that these games have a lot more gameplay than the modern PC or console games that you may be used to, and *require* you to read the instructions; they are *not* Quake. I